

Author(S): Evans-Pritchard, E. E. (Edward Evan)

Document Type: Book

Original Page: 159

Culture (OWC): Nuer (FJ22)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1931, 1936

Coverage Date: 1930-1936

Place Coverage: Sobat And Jonglei Provinces, Sudan

Section Title(S): ||

The rivalry and conflict between paternal kin of which I have spoken comes out most clearly in relations between *gaatgwanlen*, male ortho-cousins, the sons of brothers, particularly of paternal half-brothers. Enmity between half-brothers is as far as possible suppressed, or at least not given public expression, on account of the father. If brothers disagree they separate, but they try to avoid scandal. Difference of generations inhibits either familiarity or declared hostility between a man and his paternal uncles, but the sons of these uncles are of his own generation and he can be as intimate or quarrelsome with them as he pleases. He is bound to them by ties of loyalty which do not derive from, or depend on, either mutual affection or common affection for a third person, as is the case with half-brothers who share the same father, and which generally necessitate close contact in situations likely sometimes to engender conflict. It is perhaps this contradiction between social bonds and personal feelings which gives rise to the joking or teasing relationship between ortho-cousins.

593
Family Relationships

605
Cousins

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: hraf-support@yale.edu

